
Launch — Step by Step (developer handoff)

GamerGain / PlayEarning Nexus · using the pre-built execution kit

How to read this: every step is tagged with who does it —

👤 **OWNER** (only you can; needs your identity/card) · ⚡ **DEVELOPER** (following the kit) ·

📁 **SCRIPT** ([launch.sh](#) does it) · ⏸ **WAIT** (external review/approval; nobody can rush it).

Cost of the developer's part: with the automation now in the kit (see the cheat-sheet at the bottom), the ⚡ steps total **~30-45 hours at \$75/hour = ~\$2,250-\$3,375** for the full PWA + Android + iOS launch — or **~\$2,850-\$4,275 with the user-capacity load test**. The 👤 owner steps and the fixed fees (Apple \$99/yr, Google \$25, domain, hosting) are separate — see [GamerGain-Launch-Estimate.pdf](#). The per-phase hours below are the pre-automation figures; the cheat-sheet scripts bring them down.

PHASE 0 — Create the accounts (👤 OWNER) · ~a few hours of signups

You do these first; the developer can't (they need your identity, card, and legal agreement). Create an account and get the key for each, then write them into [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#):

- Hosting: **Railway** ([railway.app](#))
- Database: **Railway Postgres** (or Neon/Supabase)
- AI: **OpenAI** (or Anthropic)
- Email: **SendGrid** (or SES)
- File storage: **AWS S3**
- Payments: **Stripe** and **PayPal**
- Surveys: **BitLabs**
- SMS (optional): **Twilio**
- Google sign-in (optional): **Google Cloud OAuth**
- Mobile: **Apple Developer** (\$99/yr) and **Google Play Console** (\$25)
- A **domain** for your app

PHASE 1 — Fill in the keys (👤 OWNER) · ~30 min

- Open [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#) and paste in every value from Phase 0.
- Hand the developer: the repo, this file, and the filled-in worksheet. They now have everything.

PHASE 2 — Prep & validate (⚡ DEVELOPER + 📁 SCRIPT) · ~2-3 h

- Developer puts the keys into [backend/.env](#), then runs: `bash deploy-kit/launch.sh`.
- The script (📁) checks the keys, generates the secrets that can be auto-made, validates the build, loads the database schema (if `psql /DATABASE_URL` available), and smoke-tests the backend.

PHASE 3 — Deploy the backend, scheduler & frontend (⚡ DEVELOPER) · ~8-11 h

- Follow [railway/RAILWAY-DEPLOY.md](#) exactly: create the Railway project, add Postgres, deploy the backend + scheduler + frontend, set the env vars, generate the domains.
- Done when: [/health](#) is green, the scheduler logs show cron jobs, and the site loads and can sign up.

PHASE 4 — Test the money & earn loops (🔗 DEVELOPER) · ~12-16 h

- Run `PAYMENTS-TEST-CHECKLIST.md` (Stripe/PayPal sandbox → live, buy-credit, partner payout).
- Run `SURVEY-LOOP-TEST.md` (BitLabs → credit → agent → oversight).
- Run `QA-CHECKLIST.md` on the live site.
- Run `LOAD-TEST-PLAN.md` — this is the **user-capacity test**: measure how many concurrent users the app handles, find where it bends first, and resize the servers from the real numbers. (+8-12 h; this is what turns "should handle 100k" into a measured figure you can trust.)

PHASE 5 — Build & submit the apps (🔗 DEVELOPER + ⌚ WAIT) · ~15-22 h + review wait

- Add the signing secrets (see `ANDROID-SUBMISSION-KIT.md` / `IOS-NO-MAC-KIT.md`), then in GitHub → **Actions** run **Android Build & Play** and **iOS Build & TestFlight** (builds in the cloud — no Mac).
- 👤 OWNER + 🔗 DEVELOPER: fill the store listings (copy is provided), add the demo login, submit.
- ⌚ WAIT for Google and Apple review (days; iOS can need a resubmit — the kit's reviewer notes help).

PHASE 6 — Legal (👤 OWNER, in parallel) · not developer time

- Get the provided Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by a lawyer; publish them at public URLs.

PHASE 7 — Go live (🔗 DEVELOPER) · final checks

- Point your custom domain + HTTPS, flip payments to live, confirm the go-live checklist, turn the cron schedules on.

The hand-off checklist (give the developer all of this)

- [] The repo (already on GitHub) + this `LAUNCH-STEP-BY-STEP.md`
- [] The filled-in `API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md`
- [] Access to the accounts they need to deploy (Railway, GitHub Actions secrets)
- [] The `deploy-kit/` folder (they'll follow its files phase by phase)

What only YOU (owner) must do — the short list

1. Create the accounts (Phase 0) and pay the fees (Apple \$99, Google \$25, domain, hosting).
2. Fill in the keys worksheet (Phase 1).
3. Get the legal pages lawyer-reviewed (Phase 6).
4. Approve going live.
Everything else is the developer following the kit — **~30-45 hours, ~\$2,250-\$3,375 at \$75/hr** (with the new automation).

Automation cheat-sheet (run these instead of doing it by hand)

- `node deploy-kit/env-check.mjs` — verify every key works before deploying
- `bash deploy-kit/railway/railway-deploy.sh` — provision + deploy on Railway (backend serves frontend, schema auto-loads, scheduler inline)
- `deno run -A backend/tools/seed-demo.ts` — seed demo data
- `BACKEND_URL=... node deploy-kit/e2e-smoke.mjs` — one-command critical-path smoke test
- `node backend/tools/validate-guardrails.mjs` && `node backend/tools/agent-smoke.mjs` — pre-launch agent checks
- Mobile: push to the `android-release` / `ios-release` branch (CI builds + auto-bumps the build number); `fastlane` submits
- App review: give reviewers the `/ReviewerLogin` URL (set `REVIEWER_DEMO=1`)